

Bose QuietComfort: Engineering a Market Through the Cyclic Innovation Model

How Entrepreneurship Connected Science, Technology, Product, and Market

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Today's Agenda

- 01** Introduction
- 02** Scientific
- 03** Technology
- 04** Product Creation
- 05** Market transition
- 06** Entrepreneurship
- 07** Conclusion

Introduction

From a Noisy Cockpit to a Global Product

In 1978:

Amar Bose was dissatisfied with the airline headphones he was using, which let in far too much aircraft noise for him to enjoy his music
→ a personal, everyday frustration became the starting point for a long research programme

The commercial question:

How does an acoustic principle discovered in a lab become a product that ordinary people are willing to wear, trust, and pay a premium for?

Our argument:

Bose's success cannot be explained by any single breakthrough. It reflects a sustained, cyclic interaction between four capabilities — Scientific Exploration, Technological Research, Product Development, and Market Transition — that were bridged together by entrepreneurship

The case we examine is the Bose QuietComfort family, tracing its development from the original consumer launch in 2000, through the QC25 in 2014, to the Bluetooth-enabled QC35 in 2016